

AJIT NAYAK

Growth & Transformation Leader | Strategy-Led Operator | AI-Enabled Execution | Ex-KPMG, Vedantu

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SUMMARY

Growth & Transformation Leader with **12+ years of experience** spanning management consulting, hypergrowth startups, and global enterprise-backed platforms. Trained in structured, consulting-led problem solving and proven as an operator owning **enterprise-scale growth, revenue model redesign, and margin-led execution**. Leads growth resets by rebuilding revenue architecture, correcting CAC and cost structures, and restoring execution predictability across hypergrowth, post-hyper growth correction, and large-scale restructuring. Owns the translation of enterprise strategy into operating cadence, governance, and execution systems that deliver growth and financial discipline at scale **across 0→1 and 1→10 initiatives and M&A-led transformations**.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS



Hypergrowth Scale & Cost Reset | Vedantu

Guided an entire business cycle at Vedantu through 4–5x revenue growth while overhauling cost structures and customer acquisition costs. Applied strategic frameworks to practical execution, achieving a ~70% reduction in operating costs during a post-COVID correction phase.



Enterprise Restructuring & Execution | SmartQ

Led a multi-country restructuring by merging strategic planning with operational cadence. Instituted governance systems that improved budget adherence to ~98%, turning high-level restructuring into predictable execution by building growth and operational engines.



CEO & Board-Level Transformation Leadership

Worked directly with CEOs, boards, and investors to translate strategic visions into actionable programs. Balanced a strategist's perspective with an operator's discipline, ensuring complex transformations delivered real business outcomes.



New Growth Engines & Monetization | Vedantu

Launched and scaled new revenue streams that contributed ~15% incremental topline impact. Combined a strategic lens with on-the-ground execution, turning concepts into AI-informed, scalable offerings.

EXPERIENCE

2024 - Present

Bengaluru

Director - Growth Strategy & Operations SmartQ

SmartQ is a Compass Group owned global enterprise foodtech platform operating across 15+ countries.

- **Led restructuring of a 200+ employee, multi-country organization**, redesigning the operating model and mentoring a 25-member cross-functional leadership team across product, engineering, finance, HR (culture), and operations.
- Designed and institutionalized enterprise operating cadence (**OKRs, AOPs, QBRs, product roadmap and sprint rhythms**) to align strategy, execution, and accountability across geographies.
- **Built and scaled a high-velocity hiring engine**, closing 70+ tech and product roles in ~6 months, supported by data- and AI-enabled evaluation workflows.
- Established financial utilization, budgeting, and governance systems for a cost-plus enterprise revenue model.
- Scaled the enterprise analytics platform to support predictive decision-making across consumer behavior, operations, and sales.
- Led AI-enabled workflow automation across **Engineering, Product, Marketing, Growth, and Operations** to improve execution predictability and operating visibility.
- Partnered closely with Compass Group stakeholders on restructuring priorities, operating rhythm, and multi-country coordination.

2020 - 2023

Bengaluru

Director - Strategy & CEO's Office Vedantu

Vedantu is a K-12 EdTech platform and former unicorn in India.

- **Part of the core leadership team** responsible for enterprise strategy, growth governance, and execution cadence during hypergrowth and post-hyper growth correction phases.
- **Owned strategy formulation and execution** for new initiatives, including opportunity sizing, **GTM design**, and scale-up planning across multiple test-prep formats.
- **Ran the CEO's operating cadence**, including AOPs, staff meetings, weekly priorities, and business reviews to improve leadership alignment and execution focus.
- **Designed and rolled out organization-wide OKRs** across 70+ senior leaders and managers.
- Led competitive intelligence, consumer insights, and funnel diagnostics, informing decisions on sales structure, pricing, channel mix, and market expansion.
- Owned board operations and investor coordination, including pre-board alignment, narrative preparation, and tracking of sensitive initiatives.
- **Led end-to-end M&A execution and post-merger integration** for acquisitions of **Pedagogy, Instasolv, and Deeksha**.

EXPERIENCE

2015 - 2020

Bengaluru & Mumbai

Deal Strategy & Consulting

KPMG

- Led 15–20 engagements across growth strategy, commercial due diligence, and post-merger integration for Private Equity and corporate clients across consumer internet, logistics, mobility/EV, media, infrastructure, and B2B services sectors.
- Built market, business model, revenue, and growth assessments for companies ranging from ₹200–5,000 Cr in revenue, directly influencing valuation resets, investment theses, and go / no-go decisions.
- Designed EBITDA improvement cases for efficiency, cost cuts, pricing, and redesign. Achieved 5–15% value gain in transactions.
- Led PMI planning and execution across operations, sales, technology, finance, HR, and supply chain, translating deal logic into executable 90-day, 6-month, and 12-month integration roadmaps.
- Led consulting teams, mentored staff. Managed executive client interactions and decision forums, integrating analysis with implementation.

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

03/2024

Bengaluru

GrowthX Fellow

GrowthX

- Selected to be part of a 300+ cohort comprising marketing, product, and growth leaders from top startups and companies at GrowthX. This program included bootcamp sessions on revenue-led growth strategies with a focus on acquisition, onboarding, engagement, retention, and monetization.
- Led an 8-member team on a capstone project to solve revenue growth for Topmate, a 1:1 mentoring startup. Invited by the Topmate founder to present our implementable growth strategies to achieve 5x their India revenues.

05/2023 - 06/2024

Bengaluru

Co-founder and Independent Consultant

Miredo Technologies

- Advised and led strategic and go-to-market projects for Edtech and startups.
- Co-founded a home decor venture with the vision of providing aesthetic products at affordable prices.

02/2012 - 03/2013

Bengaluru

Administrator, Teacher

Parikrma Humanity Foundation

- Parikrama educates underprivileged kids (CBSE) free of cost, former students are fashion designers, founders, lawyers and great citizens

08/2009 - 05/2011

Bengaluru

System Engineer

Infosys

- Provided application development, maintenance support, and enhancements for UK's Oil and Gas major.

EDUCATION

04/2015

Mumbai

MBA - Strategy & Finance

NMIMS, Mumbai

05/2009

Bengaluru

Bachelor of Engineering - Telecommunication

MS Ramaiah Institute of Technology

SKILLS

Growth & Revenue Strategy	Revenue Architecture	Cost & Margin Resets	Enterprise & Consumer Growth Models
Financial Governance	AI-Enabled Analytics & Automation	Growth & Transformation Leadership	
Enterprise Growth Strategy	Operating Cadence & Execution Systems (OKRs, AOPs, QBRs)		
Unit Economics (CAC, LTV, CM1–CM3)	Strategy-to-Execution Translation	Cost, Margin & CAC Resets	
Hyper growth & Post-Hyper growth Stabilization		Business Restructuring & Turnarounds	
Financial Governance & Predictability	AI-Enabled Business Transformation	M&A Execution & Post-Merger Integration	